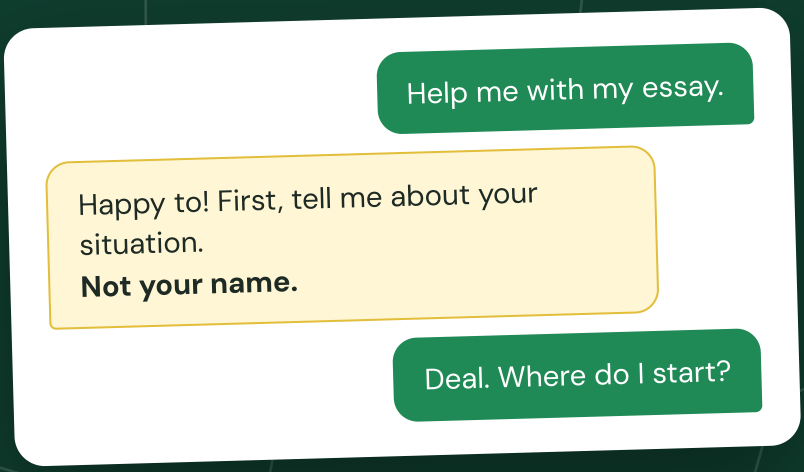
A 10-STEP GUIDE · FILL IN AS YOU GO

Make *Free AI* Work for You

বিনামূল্যের AI-কে নিজের সহকারী বানান — পরিচয় গোপন রেখে

Build your own AI assistant in ten simple steps, and keep your private life private while you do it.



Plain words · Fill-in pages · Real cases

Share your situation. Keep your identity.

A GUIDE BY ONNOY · অন্বয়

Make Free AI Work for You

Build your own AI assistant in ten simple steps

বিনামূল্যের AI-কে নিজের সহকারী বানান

FIRST EDITION	September 2026. Published in Mymensingh, Bangladesh.
PUBLISHED BY	Onnoy · অন্বয় — a youth-led decision-making mentorship initiative for students, parents and teachers.
MADE BY	Team Onnoy. Written, designed and tested with students before it reached print.
TYPE	Playfair Display and DM Sans. Bangla set in Noto Sans Bengali.

COPYING	© Onnoy 2026. Licensed under Creative Commons BY-NC-SA 4.0: you may photocopy, share and adapt this booklet for non-commercial use if you credit Onnoy and share it under the same terms.

A NOTE ON PRODUCTS	This booklet names real AI apps and real news events for teaching only. Onnoy is not connected to any AI company. Features and menus change; see the edition date on the back cover.
FIND US	Onnoy on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for "Onnoy".

Contents

How this works 4

LEARN THE BASICS

01 Meet your AI 5

02 Know me, not me 9

03 Your Background Card 17

BUILD YOUR ASSISTANT

04 Give it a home 21

05 Give it instructions 25

USE IT WELL

06 Your first task 29

07 Save your progress 33

TRUST IT WISELY

08 Check before you trust 36

09 Make a decision 40

10 Keep it sharp 44

KEEP THESE PAGES

Power Words 47

Your one-page cheat sheet 49

My notes 50

About Onnoy 51

BEFORE YOU START

Here is how this works.

Grab a pen.
Many pages have lines to fill in. What you write becomes your assistant's memory.

One idea per page.
Read it, try it, turn the page. Each one takes about a minute.

Copy the yellow boxes.
Type them as they are. Anything in [brackets] is a blank for you to fill.

YOUR PATH

STEPS 1 TO 3
Learn the basics

STEPS 4 TO 5
Build your assistant

STEPS 6 TO 7
Use it well

STEPS 8 TO 10
Trust it wisely

The AI is a smart stranger.



YOU
knows your whole life

THE AI
has never met you

It has read an enormous amount, but it has never met **you**. It does not know your goals, your deadline or what you have already tried.

⚠ **NO BACKGROUND**

"Help me study."

You get an answer anyone could get.

✓ **WITH BACKGROUND**

"Exam in six weeks, weakest in chemistry. Make me a plan."

You get a plan built for you.

This whole book is about giving it the right background.

Every new chat starts empty.

MONDAY

Here is my exam plan. Can you improve it?

Done! Here is a stronger plan.

TUESDAY, NEW CHAT

Can we continue with my plan?

Which plan? We have not met before.

Close a chat and open a new one, and the AI starts from zero.

THE FIX

In Step 4 you will build a Project: a folder that remembers your situation, so you never have to explain yourself twice.

Some apps keep a few notes on their own. Do not rely on that.

It can be wrong and still sound sure.

Yes, I'm sure. Here are 6 sources that prove it.



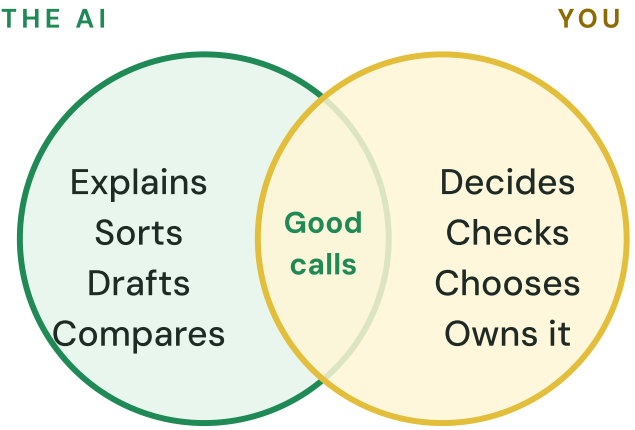
NOT ONE OF THEM EXISTS

Sometimes an AI makes things up: a date, a number, even a book that does not exist. It says them in the same calm voice as the true things, so you cannot tell by listening.

⚠ GOOD HABIT

Treat every fact it gives you as something to check, not something to trust. Step 8 shows you how.

A partner, not a boss.



The AI does the heavy lifting: it explains, sorts and drafts in seconds. But it does not know what is right for your life. You do.

Use it to think better, not to think for you.

Share your situation. Keep your identity.

Your **situation** is what you are dealing with: your exam, your deadline, your goal. Your **identity** is what points back to you: your name, phone, ID.

⚠ NOT THIS

"I'm [full name], my phone is [number], my ID number is [number]. Help me write my scholarship essay."

✓ THIS

"I'm a second-year student applying for a merit scholarship. My strongest experience is a community project. Help me outline the essay."

Let the AI know about you, but not *you*.

What is okay to tell it.

Share these freely. They describe your situation, not you.

- [ ] Your level, like "first year"
- [ ] Your subject or field
- [ ] Your goal and a rough deadline
- [ ] What you have already tried
- [ ] What you are good at and what feels hard
- [ ] How you like answers: short, simple, with examples

A QUICK TEST

Could a stranger find you from this sentence? If not, it is fine to share.

What you should never type.



- Your full name with a phone number or home address
- ID, birth certificate or passport numbers
- Passwords, OTP codes, bank or mobile-money PINs
- Photos of ID cards or certificates
- Private messages or secrets of other people, like a friend's chat

If you would not put it on a public notice board, do not type it into a chat.

⚠ IT HAPPENED · 2023

They pasted work secrets into a chatbot.

May 2023

Samsung banned these tools on company devices.

WHAT HAPPENED

Engineers at Samsung pasted confidential code and meeting notes into ChatGPT to get help.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The company said data typed into such tools goes to outside servers and is hard to get back.

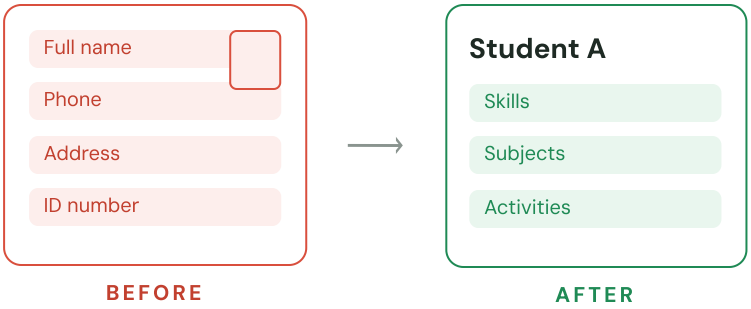
✓ THE LESSON

Once you paste something in, you cannot un-send it.

Instead: describe the problem in general words. Leave the secret part out.

Reported in 2023 by TechRadar, Bloomberg and Forbes.

Take your details out first.



BEFORE AFTER

1. Copy your CV into a new file.
2. Delete your phone, address, email, ID number and photo.
3. Change your name to "Student A".
4. Keep degrees, skills and achievements.

When you send the final CV to a real person, put your details back yourself.

⚠ IT HAPPENED · 2025

Shared chats showed up on Google.

4,500 shared chats appeared in Google search.

WHAT HAPPENED

People pressed "Share" on their ChatGPT chats and ticked a box called "Make this chat discoverable." Some of those chats held names, CVs and personal worries.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The company removed the option in August 2025. Most people had only meant to send the link to a friend.

✓ **THE LESSON**

A share link can become public. Never share a chat that has personal details in it.

Reported in 2025 by Fast Company, Engadget and Fortune.

⚠ IT HAPPENED · 2023

A bug showed strangers' chat titles.

1.2% of paying users had payment details that may have been seen by others.

WHAT HAPPENED

In March 2023 a fault in ChatGPT let some people see the titles of other users' chats. For a nine-hour window, some paying users' names, emails and last four card digits could be seen.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The service was taken offline, fixed, and the affected users were contacted.

✓ **THE LESSON**

Even big services have bugs. Do not keep secrets in a chat.

From OpenAI's own report (24 March 2023) and CNBC.

⚠ IT HAPPENED · 2023

Millions of ID numbers were exposed.

50M+ Bangladeshis' details were exposed through one website.

WHAT HAPPENED

In 2023 a researcher found names, phone numbers, email addresses and national ID numbers of more than 50 million people on a website connected to a government service.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The data was taken down after news reports. One careless website can put a whole country at risk.

✓ THE LESSON

Your ID number is a key to your life. An AI never needs it.

Reported in July 2023 by TechCrunch, Anadolu Agency and Prothom Alo.

Your Background Card.

MY BACKGROUND CARD

- About me
- What I am working on
- How I like answers

It is a short card that tells the AI who you are: the **safe** version of you.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

About five minutes. You do it once, then reuse it.

You fill it in over the next three pages. In Step 5 you copy it into your assistant's home.

Card, page 1: about me.

EXAMPLE

"I'm in my second year studying agriculture. I'm good at practical work but find long essays hard."

MY LEVEL AND SUBJECT

WHAT I AM GOOD AT

WHAT FEELS HARD

Card, page 2: what I am working on.

EXAMPLE

"I want to apply for a scholarship. The form is due in six weeks. I have started my essay outline."

MY BIG GOAL

MY NEXT STEP OR DEADLINE

WHAT I HAVE ALREADY TRIED

Card, page 3: how I like answers.

Tick what fits you. Add your own below.

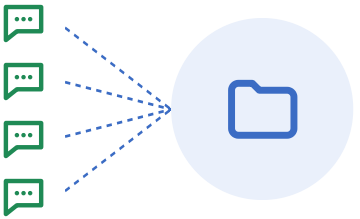
- [ ] Short and simple
- [ ] Step by step
- [ ] With examples
- [ ] Tell me if you disagree with my plan
- [ ] Ask me questions if you are unsure

ANYTHING ELSE

LAST CHECK

No name, phone, address, ID numbers or passwords on your card.

An empty chat forgets you. A Project remembers.



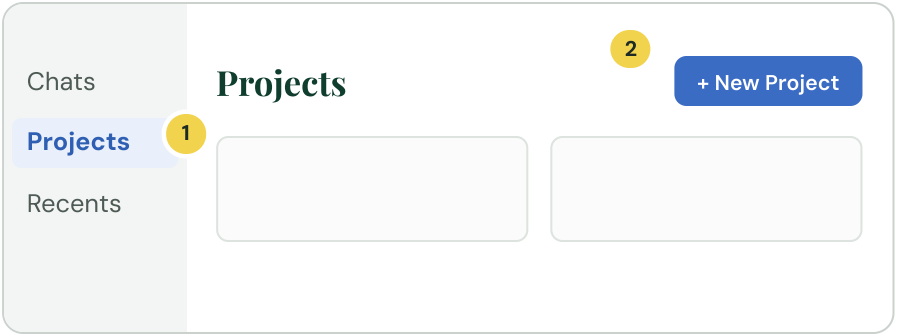
Every chat starts with your background already inside.

A **Project** is a folder inside the AI app. Whatever you put in it is there every time you start a chat inside it, so you only explain yourself once.

GOOD TO KNOW

Free accounts can make up to five Projects. One Project per goal works well.

Create your Project.



1. Open your AI app and tap **Projects** on the left.
2. Tap **+ New Project**.
3. Type a name, then create it.

Buttons can move when apps update. Look for the same words. Using another AI? Look for a saved setup, folder or "custom instructions".

Give it a clear name.

One Project for each goal. A few ideas:

Scholarship 2027	Applications and essay
Choosing my subject	Options and decisions
Semester 3 exams	Study plan
Interview prep	Practice questions

⚠ REMEMBER

The name and description are only for you. The AI does not read them. What you want it to know goes into the instructions (Step 5).

Keep only the safe you inside.



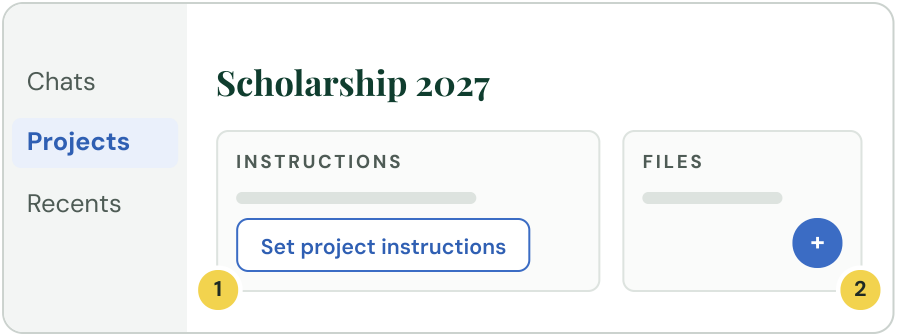
A Project remembers everything you put in it. Treat it as if a stranger might read it one day.

- [ ] My card has no name, phone or address
- [ ] No photos of ID cards or certificates
- [ ] No passwords or codes
- [ ] No private messages from other people

IF IN DOUBT

Leave it out. You can always tell the AI more later.

Open the instructions box.



1. Open your Project and tap **Set project instructions**.
2. A blank box opens. Keep it open for the next page.

WHY IT MATTERS

The AI reads this box at the start of every chat in your Project.

Paste in your card.



COPY THIS INTO THE BOX

About me: [copy from your card]

What I am working on: [copy from your card]

How to answer: Use simple words, short steps and examples.

If you are not sure about my situation, ask me questions before you answer.

If you disagree with my plan, tell me why.

Never ask for my name, phone, address or ID.

Then press **Save instructions**.

Add notes it can look at.



1. Find the area for notes and files in your Project.
2. Tap the **+** button.
3. Add a short note or file, like your private-details-free CV.
4. Only add what you are happy to share.

REMEMBER

Chats in a Project do not automatically remember each other. What stays is your instructions and the notes you add.

Test your assistant.

What do you know about me and what I am working on?

You are in your second year, applying for a scholarship, and you like short, simple answers.

Start a new chat inside your Project and ask the question above. Then check:

- [ ] It knows my level and goal
- [ ] It does not know my name or phone
- [ ] It asks questions when it is unsure

✓ IT WORKS

All three ticked? Your assistant is ready. If not, go back and fix your instructions.

Use the 4-line message.

Say it in this order. It takes 30 seconds and gets you much better answers.

1. **Who I am**
   "I'm a first-year university student."

2. **What is happening**
   "I must pick an elective by Friday."

3. **What I want**
   "Help me decide."

4. **How to answer**
   "Pros and cons in a table."

SHORTCUT

Inside your Project, line 1 is already known. Start from line 2.

A message you can copy.

Here is the 4-line message in action. Line 1 is skipped because your Project already knows who you are.

COPY AND CHANGE

I have to choose between two elective courses by Friday.

Help me decide.

Give me the pros and cons in a table, then ask me what matters most.

NOW WRITE YOUR OWN FIRST TASK

Let it ask you.

I am not sure how to explain my situation.

No problem. First question: what are you trying to decide?

COPY THIS

I am not sure how to explain my situation. Ask me questions, one at a time, until you understand. Then help me.

WHY IT WORKS

One question at a time is easier than writing one long explanation.

Talk first. Tidy later.



You do not need neat sentences. Type everything on your mind, then ask the AI to sort it.

COPY THIS

Here is everything on my mind about [topic]. It is messy. First sort it into groups. Then tell me what is missing.

BEFORE YOU SEND

Take out names and numbers.

Save your progress.


GOOD CHAT


SUMMARY


YOUR PROJECT

At the end of a useful chat, ask the AI to sum up what you decided. Add that summary to your Project. Your next chat starts smarter.

WHY BOTHER

Without a save-point, every new chat starts from scratch.

Chat. Summarise. Save. Repeat.

The save-point message.



COPY THIS AT THE END OF A CHAT

Sum up this chat in 5 lines: what I decided, what I still need to do, and anything you should remember next time. Leave out names and numbers.

1. Send the message.
2. Copy the answer.
3. Add it to your Project as a note, or under "Latest update" in your instructions.

Refresh it once a month.



- [ ] Has my goal changed?
- [ ] Has a deadline passed?
- [ ] Did I learn how I like answers?
- [ ] Is there old information to remove?

MY NEXT REFRESH DATE

TIP

Set a reminder on your phone so you do not forget.

Ask where it got that.



COPY THIS

What is this based on? Give me sources I can check.

CAREFUL

If it gives a book, link or name, look it up yourself. Sometimes they do not exist.

1. Ask where it got that.
2. Open the source yourself.
3. Check it really says that.

⚠ IT HAPPENED · 2023

The AI invented six court cases.

$5,000 fine for lawyers who trusted fake cases.

WHAT HAPPENED

Two New York lawyers used ChatGPT to find past cases for a court document. It made up six that looked real, and told them they were real when they asked.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The judge fined the lawyers and their firm in June 2023. The problem was not using AI. It was not checking.

✓ **THE LESSON**

Check before you trust, even when the AI says it is sure.

Court order of 22 June 2023, as reported by AP and CNN.

Check big facts twice.



1. Find one more source: an official website, a textbook or a teacher.
2. Compare it with the AI's answer.
3. If they differ, trust the official source.

⚠ ALWAYS CHECK

Deadlines, fees, rules, numbers and names of people.

Two sources beat one.

Ask how fresh the answer is.

The AI learned from information up to a certain date. Rules, fees and deadlines change.

COPY THIS

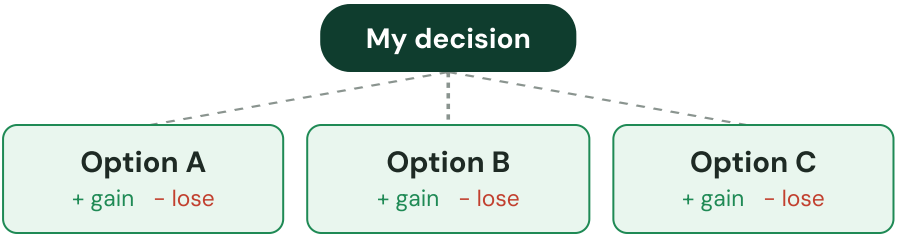
How up to date is this? What should I double-check on an official website?

EVEN BETTER

If your app can search the web, ask it to search and show you the links.

Facts get old. Check the date.

Ask for options, not orders.



NOT THIS

"What should I do?"

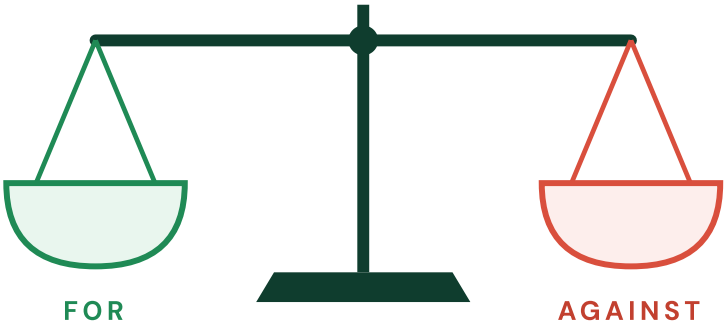
THIS

"I need to decide [X]. Give me three options and what I gain and lose in each."

WHY

You get to think. The AI helps you see.

Ask for the case against.



It is easy to hear only what you want to hear. Ask for the other side.

COPY THIS

Argue against my plan. What could go wrong?

OR TRY

What would a smart critic say about this plan?

Ask what it is guessing.

Guess: you want the easy option.

Guess: you have lots of free time.

Guess: money is not a problem.

The AI fills gaps with guesses. Wrong guesses lead to wrong advice.

COPY THIS

List the guesses you made about me. What am I missing?

Wrong guess in, wrong advice out.

Put it on one page.

Fill in your options. Then ask: "Which option fits what matters most to me?" You make the final call.

OPTION	I GAIN	I LOSE	RISK	MY GUT
OPTION A			☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High	
OPTION B			☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High	
OPTION C			☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High	

When an answer is not good.

You never need to start over. Just tell it what to fix.

Too long	Shorter, please.
Too hard	Use simpler words.
Too vague	Give me an example.
Missed a point	You missed [X]. Try again.
Not what I meant	Ask me what I meant.

TIP

Say it the way you would to a friend. Short is fine.

Check your privacy settings.



1. Open your AI app's Settings.
2. Look for words like **privacy** or **data**.
3. Read what they say. Choose what you are comfortable with.
4. Delete old chats you do not need.

⚠ BEFORE YOU SHARE

Read a chat fully before you press Share. Links can spread.

A long chat gets messy.



When the AI starts repeating or forgetting, it is time for a fresh chat.

1. Ask for a save-point summary.
2. Open a new chat inside the same Project.
3. Paste the summary as your first message.

GOOD TO KNOW

Starting fresh is not a failure. It is a reset.

REFERENCE

Power words: shape answers.

WORD	MEANING	TRY SAYING
Role	Who the AI acts like	*"Act as a strict reviewer."*
Audience	Who it is for	*"Explain for a beginner."*
Tone	How it sounds	*"Use a friendly, formal tone."*
Format	The shape of the answer	*"Give it as a table."*
Length	How long	*"Keep it under 150 words."*
Constraints	Rules it must follow	*"Only use what I told you."*
Example	A sample to copy	*"Write it like this: …"*
Step by step	One stage at a time	*"Walk me through it."*

Role changes how it sounds, not how much it knows. Still check the facts.

REFERENCE

Power words: think sharper.

WORD	MEANING	TRY SAYING
Assumptions	What it takes for granted	*"List your assumptions."*
Trade-offs	What you gain and lose	*"Show the trade-offs."*
Alternatives	Other ways to do it	*"Give me three alternatives."*
Devil's advocate	The case against	*"Argue against my plan."*
Sources	Where it comes from	*"What is this based on?"*
Confidence	How sure it is	*"How confident are you?"*
Prioritise	Put in order of importance	*"Prioritise these by urgency."*
Gaps	What is missing	*"What am I missing?"*

These words help because they are specific, not because they are magic.

KEEP THIS PAGE

Your one-page cheat sheet.

- [ ] Tell it about your situation, not your identity.
- [ ] Work inside your Project.
- [ ] Let it ask you questions.
- [ ] Never type IDs, passwords or other people's secrets.
- [ ] Use the 4-line message.
- [ ] Save your progress at the end of a chat.
- [ ] Ask where it got that. Check big facts twice.
- [ ] Ask for options and the case against.
- [ ] Fix it by talking: shorter, simpler, an example.
- [ ] You make the final call.

THE 4 LINES

Who I am. What is happening. What I want. How to answer.

MY NOTES

Things I want to remember.

Good messages, answers worth keeping, questions for the next session.

About Onnoy.

Onnoy (অন্বয়: "connection") is a youth-led mentorship initiative in Mymensingh, Bangladesh. We help students, and the parents and teachers who guide them, make better decisions: what to study, what to believe online, and how to use new tools without giving themselves away.

Onnoy began in 2026 in the Changemakers' Programme of Amra Notun Network and BRAC Youth Platform. The cohort ended; the work did not. Students who finish our sessions go on to mentor others, and everything we publish is drafted, checked and tested by the team before it reaches a classroom.

Sessions

Hands-on workshops in schools and colleges. Students do; we don't lecture.

Booklets

Short, printable guides like this one. Free to copy for non-commercial use.

Peer mentors

Students who finish a session help the next group, so the habit outlives the visit.

For parents & teachers

Plain-language material for the adults students turn to first.

WANT A SESSION AT YOUR SCHOOL, COLLEGE OR CLUB?

Message us on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for Onnoy.

Your assistant is only as good as what you tell it.

- Tell it about your **situation**, not your identity.
- Give it a **home** so you never explain yourself twice.
- **Check** what it says. Then make the call yourself.

Onnoy

Connecting Necessary Dots

অন্বয়

SCAN TO FIND ONNOY ON FACEBOOK

ALSO FROM ONNOY

What to Study? · a subject-choice guide

অনিমা (Onima) · a picture story about attention

Menus and buttons in AI apps change from time to time. If something looks different, look for the same words. The steps in this edition were checked in September 2026.

FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026 MYMENSINGH, BANGLADESH